**BUSINESS & ECONOMY** | Business Resilience

**CRISIS COMPASS:** Surviving lows and lockdowns. And what it takes to bounce back, and thrive

# STAYIN' ALIVE

**The Covid pandemic had a devastating impact on lives and livelihoods.** An estimated 140 million people lost their jobs, while millions of others faced salary cuts. The industries that suffered the most were those providing personal-touch services: tourism, hospitality, entertainment and aviation. They are now on the path to recovery, and have given us valuable lessons in resilience. SpiceJet experimented with a new business model of carrying only cargo on its commercial aircraft, since it could not carry passengers. It helped the airline keep its head above water, while serving an important cause of carrying medicines and PPE kits, said CEO Ajay Singh. For Indian Hotels, part of the Tata Group, the pandemic opened an avenue to do good by distributing meals to frontline workers, and successfully try new business streams like home delivery and homestays, said MD and CEO Puneet Chhatwal. For multiplex firm PVR, the pandemic meant pruning its costs, finding new ways to raise funds and even merging with No. 2 player Inox for a stronger balance sheet. ■



MANISH RAJPUT

**PUNEET CHHATWAL**
*MD and CEO, Indian Hotels Company*

**We, at present, are 30 per cent ahead compared to 2019-20 at an enterprise level. In the last quarter, our profit was higher than the profit in the best financial year**

## LESSONS ON RESILIENCE
*What the pandemic taught them*

**PUNEET CHHATWAL**
- If you give once, you will get back the good 10 times over
- Look after your people, because they look after the guests
- Don't take shortcuts... They create long-term challenges

**AJAY SINGH**
- Try to find an opportunity in a crisis. It keeps you optimistic
- We realised the importance of automation in our business
- Never presume that the worst can't hit you

**AJAY BIJLI**
- In good times and bad times, take care of your stakeholders
- There's no point in maintaining the facade of remaining positive
- You need to back everything up with statistics